

SOCIOLOGY 101 · ANSWER KEY - PROFESSOR COPY

Homework 1: Who Works in a NICU?

Grading guide. Total 21 points. Answers in different words that mean the same thing get full credit; partial credit is suggested where it applies. Enter the final score in Professor mode on the recitation page.

Part A — Match the team member to the job

1. Draw a line from each NICU team member to what they mostly do. (6 pts)

Answer: Neonatologist -> Leads the medical plan and makes the big decisions on rounds | NICU nurse -> Cares for the baby at the bedside hour after hour | Respiratory therapist -> Runs the ventilators and CPAP and helps at deliveries | Pharmacist -> Prepares TPN recipes and checks every medicine dose | Lactation consultant -> Helps mothers pump and provide breast milk | Social worker -> Supports the family – housing, money worries, stress, paperwork (1 pt each)

Part B — Your own society

2. Draw a chart of a group you belong to – your household, your classroom, or a team. Put each person (or role) in a box and write one job they have in the group. Draw lines between people who work together directly. (2 pts)

Answer: At least three people/roles with a job each (1 pt) and connecting lines (1 pt). Any real group counts.

Part C — Which level of care?

3. Write the level of newborn unit (I, II, III, or IV) that fits each baby. (4 pts)

Answer: I; II; III (IV is also acceptable – a Level IV does everything a III does); IV.

Part D — Short answers

4. Why is the person who cleans the NICU part of the care team? Use the word infection in your answer. (2 pts)

Answer: Preemies have weak immune systems and infection is one of the biggest dangers; cleaning surfaces and equipment is infection control – it is medicine. 1 pt for the infection idea, 1 pt for connecting cleaning to protecting the babies.

5. In your own words, what does regionalization of newborn care mean? (1 pt)

Answer: Organizing hospitals so the sickest/smallest babies are born in – or moved to – the hospitals that have the right level of care for them.

6. Why do morning rounds follow the same order every day? (1 pt)

Answer: A. So nothing gets skipped and everyone knows when to speak. - Routines make groups reliable — that's a sociology idea you can see every morning in a NICU.

Part E — Flashback**7. From NICU Tutor: what are “rounds”? (1 pt)**

Answer: The team's morning walk from bed to bed, checking every baby and making the day's plan.

8. From NICU Tutor: a pulse oximeter alarm goes off. What does a good nurse do FIRST, and why? (1 pt)

Answer: Look at the baby first — the probe may have slipped, or the baby may truly need help. Machines report; humans judge.

Part F — Think like a doctor**9. A new nurse notices a baby's color looks wrong, but the senior doctor has just said the baby is fine and moved on. What should the team's culture be so that the baby is safe — and why does that matter more than who is senior? (3 pts)**

Answer: The culture should make it safe and expected for anyone — including the newest nurse — to speak up, and for seniors to listen and go look (1 pt). The nurse spends the most time at the bedside and often notices first (1 pt). Babies are harmed when people stay quiet out of respect for rank; safety depends on the whole team's eyes, not one person's title (1 pt).